son, could not be adopted under Hindu law. When J. D. Mayne's 'Treatise on Hindu Law and Usage' was consulted, his argument was annulled. Yet, he insisted on adopting a distant relation, citing religious requirements. He argued that in Hinduism, when one did not have a son, one had to adopt one so that he could perform the annual *shraaddha* or ritual remembrance of his departed father's soul. The Viceroy of India then clearly informed him that the Government of India had decided that Raja Amar Singh and his son, Hari Singh, would be the successors to Pratap Singh's rule.[19]

The embittered Maharaja Pratap Singh never accepted this decision and, despite the Viceroy's communication on the subject, in 1907, he actually adopted Raja Jagat Dev Singh of Poonch, a descendant of Raja Dhyan Singh, the younger brother of Maharaja Gulab Singh. The Government of India, thereafter, wrote to him informing him that this adoption would not affect the rights of Pratap Singh's closest relatives.

While the Anglo-Russian Convention of 1907 secured the British enough to reinstate the Maharaja, the Government of India could not let its guard down for too long. The Russian Revolution of 1917 and the British support to the White Russian armies had re-established the rivalry between Britain and Russia. The embattled Bolshevik regime in Russia that was fighting the pro-Western White Russian armies, during the Russian Civil War, decided to establish the Comintern or Communist International in March 1919. The leaders of Bolshevik Russia announced that the only way they could preserve the revolution was to fight back against the Western powers and spread communism throughout the world via the Comintern.

The obvious corollary of this decision was to take the fight to India, the jewel in the crown of the British Empire. Earlier in July 1918, Maj Gen. Sir Wilfrid Malleson of the Indian Army led an expedition of both British and Indian troops to Turkestan, Russia, during the Civil War. The Indian troops of the 19th Punjab Rifles engaged Bolshevik forces and defeated them at Merv, in what is present-day Turkmenistan. This was the first direct military confrontation between British and Russian troops since the Crimean War of 1853–54. The 19th Punjab Rifles' contingent was reinforced in September 1918 by troops from the 28th Light Cavalry, which was merged into the 7th